

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCE

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

TO : SHOLASTICA JERE

FROM : TAONGA KAMANGA

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TASK : DISCUSSING SEVERAL TYPES OF LISTENING AND HOW THEY ARE APPLIED ON CAMPUS WITH THEIR THEORETICAL JUSTIFICATION

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Grant (2016) said that, “Listening is not about waiting for your turn to talk; it is about genuinely absorbing what others are saying”. Therefore, students must ensure that there is an effective listening as part of the communication process on campus. Marshal (2015), described listening as an active process of understanding, not just a passive activity of hearing. It involves giving your full attention an being fully present with the speaker. There are several types of listening. Therefore, this essay accounts some of them in detail.

To begin with, appreciative listening. According to Ducks and McMahon (2015), they both described appreciative listening as listening with a positive mindset and an openness to appreciate and enjoy the message being conveyed. It focuses on finding value and enjoyment in what the speaker is saying, rather than solely on analyzing or critiquing it. Appreciative listeners express enthusiasm, encouragement, and admiration for the speaker’s words, ideas, or experiences. They seek to cultivate a supportive and uplifting atmosphere that enhances the communication process and strengthens relationships. Campuses often host cultural events. Appreciative listening is important during these events to understand and respect different cultural perspectives, traditions, and experiences being shared.

Secondly, comprehensive listening. Hybels and Weaver (2015), defined comprehensive listening as a type of listening that involves engaging yourself with the speaker’s message by fully understanding not only the explicit content but also implicit meanings, emotions, and intentions conveyed. It emphasizes attentive and thorough processing of the entire communication, enabling a deeper comprehension of the speaker’s perspective. Comprehensive listening is beneficial in group discussions, where students must actively engage with their peers’ ideas, perspectives and concerns to foster effective collaboration and problem solving. Overall, applying comprehensive listening on campus fosters a culture of attentive and empathic communication, contributing to more enriching educational experience for all stakeholders.

Not only comprehensive listening but also active listening. (Chiu and Lin, 2018) described active listening as a deliberate and focused listening process where the listener is fully engaged and attentive to the speaker’s message. They emphasized that active listening involves not only hearing the words spoken but also actively processing the information, interpreting the speaker’s message, and making efforts to understand the underlying meaning. This includes providing feedback, asking clarifying questions, and demonstrating empathy towards the speaker’s perspective. By actively engaging with the speaker, listeners can enhance their

overall listening skill and effectively grasp the content being communicated. On campus, active listening can be applied in classrooms. Lecturers including instructors can pose questions, encourage discussions, and incorporate activities that prompt students to listen attentively, process information, and respond thoughtfully. By actively participating in discussions and providing answers to their classmates, students can strengthen their listening comprehension abilities and deepen their understanding of course materials.

Furthermore, critical listening. This is a type of listening where students engage in active analysis and evaluation of information, seeking to understand the deeper meaning, assumptions, and implications of what they hear, Peacock (2012). This type of listening goes beyond surface-level comprehension and encourages students to critically evaluate the sources, identify biases, and asses the validity of arguments. It is essential in campus organizations and extracurricular activities like debate clubs, student government or advocacy groups where they engage in discussions where critical listening skills are crucial for understanding different viewpoints, evaluating arguments, and making informed decisions.

Lastly, empathic listening. Davis (2016), defined empathic listening as a type of listening characterized by deep understanding, sensitivity, and emotional connection with the speaker. It goes beyond simply hearing words to actively turning in to the speaker's feelings, thoughts and perspectives. Empathic listening requires the listener to be fully present, attentive, and non-judgmental. It can be beneficial in academic settings, student support services such as counselling centers and peer support groups. Here, trained professionals and peer counselors employ empathic listening to create a safe and non-judgmental space for students to express their concerns, share their experiences, and seek emotional support.

In conclusion, effective communication involves various types of listening which include appreciative, comprehensive listening, active listening, critical listening, and empathic listening. Each of these types saves a unique purpose in understanding, interpreting, and responding to the message conveyed. By recognizing and applying these paradigms, individuals can navigate various communication contexts skillfully, build stronger relationships, and achieve greatest communication success on this planet.

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